an eye in an operation and was referred to as the ‘One-Eyed Raja’ by his peers—could be the same person as this Sivaraja Master. Anirudhya called and thanked his IB contact and asked if he could get more information on the man. It was increasingly becoming clear that Sivaraja, Sivarasan, Sivarajan, Sivaraja Master and Raghuvaran were likely the same person. Aliases were created to confuse the security agencies. Anirudhya was armed with the full information from the dossier on Raghuvaran that was available with the Colombo unit of R&AW. A copy of that must have been with the agencies in India by then. The source told to wait before Anirudhya published anything.

Just around the same time, a woman dropped into Malligai in response to the public appeal by the SIT seeking information on the suspected assassins. She was volunteering information. The female constables posted at Malligai screened her and took her inside after due approval from Kaarthikeyan’s office and made her sit in Ragothaman’s cabin. Verma walked in. Ragothaman switched on the tape recorder.

The woman made sensational claims. She said she had witnessed the assassination of Rajiv Gandhi and recalled photographer Haribabu, the kurta-pyjama-clad man and the human bomb carrying the garland. According to her, they were moving about with two other women in Sriperumbudur. Verma showed her the enlarged copies of Haribabu’s photographs. She identified the two women in the enclosure seen in one of the ten photographs and said she had seen them before the blast.

Verma had four faces before him that were now suspected to be involved in the assassination—the human bomb, the man in the kurta pyjama and the two women sitting in the women’s enclosure. One was dead and the rest of the three were missing.

On the night of 11 June, Ragothaman and his team raided the printing press ‘BPL Allrounders’. They picked up Bhagyanathan and brought him to the SIT office. He was shown the photo of the women’s enclosure that Haribabu had taken. Bhagyanathan said he didn’t know what the photo was about. Then Verma showed him the photo the SIT had seized from Ravi Shankar’s album that had one of the two girls—Nalini. Bhagyanathan